

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR INSPECTOR OF STATISTICS
UNDER PLANNING & PROGRAMME IMPLEMENTATION DEPARTMENT,
GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(MARCH-2026)

PAPER-I
(GENERAL ENGLISH)

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 150

Mark for each question is indicated against it.

1. Write an essay choosing one of the topics given below: (20)
- (a) Sairang Rail Station: A Catalyst for Infrastructure Development in Mizoram
 - (b) Mental Health and Work Environment
 - (c) Strengthening Good Governance through Official Statistics
 - (d) The Digital Generation: How Technology is Changing Childhood and Youth.

2. Write a precis of the following passage: (10)

Self-reliance is the pilgrim's best staff, the worker's best tool. It is the master key that unlocks all the difficulties of life. 'Help yourself and Heaven will help you' is a maxim that receives daily confirmation. He who begins with crutches will generally end with crutches. Help from within always strengthens, but help from without invariably weakens the recipients. The habit of depending upon others should be vigorously resisted, since it tends to weaken the intellectual faculties and paralyse the judgement. The struggle against adverse circumstances has, on the contrary, a strengthening effect, like that of the pure mountain air on an enfeebled frame.

This is a lesson which is not taught in academic institutions nowadays. The vice of the modern system of education is that it lays down too many royal roads to knowledge. The difficulties, which formerly compelled the student to think and labour for himself are now mire carefully removed. The race of thorough and complete scholars is dying out. Our young men are equipped to such an extent with manuals that explain everything and guides that go everywhere, that they find no occasion for thought. Why take any trouble at all when so many are willing to relieve you of it?

Direction (Question Nos. 3 -12): Read the following passage and answer the questions based on the given passage.

Many people believe that science and religion are contrary to each other. But this notation is wrong. As a matter of fact, both are correlated to each other. There is no doubt that the method of science and religion are different. The method of science is observation, experimentation and experience. Science takes its recourse to progressive march towards perfection. The rules of religion are faith, intuition and spoken word of the enlightened. In general, while science is inclined towards reason and rationality, spiritualism is the essence of religion.

In earlier times when man appeared on Earth, he was over-awed at the sight of violent and powerful aspects of nature. In certain cases, the usefulness of different natural objects of nature overwhelmed man. Thus began the worship of forces of nature — fire, the sun, the rivers, the rocks, the trees, the snakes etc. The holy scriptures were written by those who had developed harmony between external nature and their inner self. Their objective was to ennoble, elevate and liberate the human spirit and mind. But the priestly class took upon itself the monopoly of scriptural knowledge and interpretation to its own advantage. Thus, the entire human race was in chains. Truth was flouted and progressive, liberal and truthful ideas or ideas expressing doubt and scepticism were suppressed and their holders punished. It was in these trying circumstances that science emerged as a saviour of mankind. But its path was not smooth and safe. The scientists and free thinkers were tortured. This was the fate of Copernicus, Galileo, Bruno and others. But side by side science gained ground.

3. Why does man worship the force of nature? (2)
4. Why is it said in the passage that ‘science emerged as a saviour of mankind’? (2)
5. According to the passage, science and religion both: (2)
 - (a) Emerged out of the fear of man
 - (b) Emerged from the desire of man to worship the forces of nature
 - (c) Employs different methods of inquiry
 - (d) Work at the cross-purpose of each other
6. According to the passage, at the present juncture, there is a need to: (2)
 - (a) teach people to worship the forces of nature
 - (b) encourage spiritualism as much as possible
 - (c) judiciously mix the principles of science and true spirit of religion
 - (d) free man from all sorts of bondages
7. Choose the antonym of the word ‘non-contradictory’ (2)
8. Which of the following statements is true in the context of the passage? (2)
 - (a) Science and religion are antagonistic to each other
 - (b) Science encourages worshipping of nature
 - (c) Religion is essential for external peace and harmony
 - (d) Regimental religion was replaced by scientific principles
9. Which of the following statements is not true in the context of the passage? (2)
 - (a) Man worships the forces of nature
 - (b) Methods of science and religion are different
 - (c) Regimental religion got degenerated into orthodoxy
 - (d) Galileo and Bruno were disciples of Copernicus

10. According to the passage, *truth* was: (2)
(a) flouted (b) progressive
(c) both (a) & (b) (d) None of the above
11. What was the objective of the authors of the holy scriptures? (2)
(a) To teach man the methods of worshipping nature
(b) To educate and raise the human spirit and mind
(c) To develop harmony between external nature and their inner self
(d) None of these
12. Find the synonym of the word 'dazzled/impressed'. (2)
13. Make sentences with **any five** to bring out the difference in their meaning (5×2=10)
(a) Emerge/Immerse (b) Pair/Pare
(c) Teem/Team (d) Antique/Antic
(e) Compliment/Complement (f) Hail/Hale
(g) Wave/Waive (h) Proscribe/Prescribe
14. Supply suitable one-word substitutes for **any ten** of the following: (10×2=20)
(a) Incapable of making errors (b) Fluent and clear in speech
(c) One who hates war, loves peace (d) A remedy for all ills
(e) Exactly as it was spoken or written (f) A connoisseur of food
(g) An imaginary name assumed by an author (h) Medicine given to counteract poison
(i) One who lives in solitude (j) An examination of living tissue
(k) An official pardon (l) Flower fastened in a circle
15. Supply appropriate synonyms for **any five** of the following: (5×2=10)
(a) Concur (b) Overbearing
(c) Mitigate (d) Prodigy
(e) Vagrant (f) Brittle
(g) Disdain
16. Supply appropriate antonyms for **any five** of the following: (5×2=10)
(a) Moderate (b) Jubilant
(c) Eccentric (d) Nepotism
(e) Transient (f) Spurious
(g) Abound
17. Make sentences with **any five** of the following idioms/phrases to bring out their meaning: (5×2=10)
(a) Hold water (b) Bird's eye view
(c) Apple-pie order (d) To miss the bus
(e) A small fry (f) Gordian knot
(g) Damp squib
18. Change the voice: (5×2=10)
(a) The chef is cooking a special dish
(b) How did you open the door?
(c) Tea shall not be taken by me today
(d) By whom were you insulted?
(e) Mistakes were made

19. Complete the following by using question tags:

(5×2=10)

- (a) Let us go, _____?
- (b) He isn't very happy with it _____?
- (c) Mind your business, _____?
- (d) Keep your mouth shut _____?
- (e) Don't break the glass _____?

20. Rewrite the following sentences as directed:

(10×2=20)

- (a) How long have you _____ him? (Fill in using the verb **know**)
- (b) The sun was shining. We went for a walk. (Change into Compound sentence)
- (c) Having finished his work, he went home. (Change into Complex sentence)
- (d) You have to pay or you cannot leave this place. (Change into Simple sentence)
- (e) She said, "You see, you cannot meet the principal". (Change into Indirect speech)
- (f) Portia exclaimed with sorrow that she was ruined. (Change into Direct speech)
- (g) Waste not, want not. (Begin the sentence with **if**)
- (h) I do not know her nature any better than you. (use positive degree)
- (i) His prompt reply will able us to take timely action. (Correct/improve the sentence)
- (j) Shall we ever forget these happy days. (Rewrite using **never**)

* * * * *